

Prother — Product Requirements Document (Master)

Product: Prother — *Where AI products launch.*
Domain: **prother.dev** (acquired)
Version: 2.0 — Master, consolidates v1.0–v1.2
Status: Approved for build
Owner: [You] (also serves as Editor role — see §8)

Document Map

SECTION	PRIMARY READER
§1–8	Everyone — strategy, rules, supply model
§9–12	Design + frontend — the four core screens
§13–16	Backend — taxonomy, requirements, schema
§17–20	You — launch, risks, timeline
Appendices A–F	Build & ops artifacts (CSV, SQL, copy)

Decision Log (final)

#	DECISION	RESOLUTION
D1	Homepage default	Launch feed (daily launches) — live ranking, UTC rollover
D2	Pre-launch tools	Live tools only (OSS: public repo with usable release/demo qualifies)
D3	Language	English-only (v1)
D4	Reviews	Account required; makers blocked from reviewing own products
D5	Quality bar	Published criteria — Standards S1–S6, public at /standards
D6	Name/domain	Prother @ prother.dev

#	DECISION	RESOLUTION
D7	Supply model	Dual-track: Editor seeds & curates; founders/startups submit their own. One unified feed, attribution badges differentiate

1. Executive Summary

Prother is a curated, community-driven launchpad and discovery platform for AI products. Every day, a fresh batch of AI tools launches on the homepage; users discover, upvote, review, and compare them; makers get a launch audience with genuine AI intent.

It combines Product Hunt's launch mechanics with a directory's searchable depth, exclusively for AI. The market need: thousands of AI tools launch monthly, scattered across GitHub, Hugging Face, X, and stale blog lists — with no trusted, community-driven place to evaluate them. Existing directories (There's An AI For That, Futurepedia) are static SEO lists with no community layer; Product Hunt buries AI launches in general noise.

Positioning: *the launch layer for AI*. "Product Hunt for AI" is internal shorthand only (trademark caution).

2. Problem Statement

#	PROBLEM	AFFECTED USERS
P1	AI tool discovery is fragmented across X, GitHub, Hugging Face, and stale "top 100" listicles	All
P2	Existing directories have no community layer — no reviews, launches, or quality signal	Evaluators
P3	Non-technical users can't evaluate fit, pricing, or alternatives	Business users
P4	AI founders lack a launch channel reaching an AI-intent audience	Makers
P5	Open-source AI projects get no exposure equivalent to commercial SaaS	Developers, OSS maintainers

3. Goals, Non-Goals, Success Metrics

Goals: (1) Default launch + discovery destination for AI tools in 12 months. (2) Community layer competitors lack. (3) Best-in-class category taxonomy & comparison. (4) Sustainable monetization by Month 9.

Non-goals (v1): hosting/running tools; building AI models; paid reviews; social features beyond core mechanics; native mobile apps.

North Star: *Weekly Active Discoverers* (view ≥1 tool page/week).

CATEGORY	METRIC	MVP+3MO	12-MONTH
Growth	MAU	25K	300K
Retention	% DAU who are return visitors	—	≥40% (by M6)
Retention	30-day return rate	15%	30%
Supply	Submissions/week	50	300
Supply	Total live listings	1,000 (500 seeded)	8,000+
Engagement	Tools viewed/session	3	5
Engagement	Median upvotes per launch	15	60
Community	Registered users	3K	50K
SEO	Organic share of sessions	40%	60%
Email	Digest subscribers	2K	40K
Email	Digest open rate / CTR	—	≥40% / ≥8%
Revenue	MRR	\$0 (deferred)	\$8–15K

4. Users & Personas

PERSONA	DESCRIPTION	PRIMARY VALUE
 Explorer	Checks AI news daily, loves novelty	Daily feed of new tools
 Builder	Builds with AI APIs; evaluates OSS	Technical depth, OSS filters, GitHub links
 Maker	Founder launching an AI product	Free launch channel + analytics
 Evaluator	Business decision-maker comparing options	Comparisons, verified reviews, pricing

PERSONA	DESCRIPTION	PRIMARY VALUE
 Analyst	Tracks the ecosystem	Trending ranks, category signals

MVP focus: Explorer + Maker (flywheel supply/demand). Monetization focus: Maker + Evaluator.

5. Brand, Domain & Legal

ITEM	DETAIL
Name / domain	Prother @ prother.dev
Tagline	"Where AI products launch." (locked for waitlist; final pre-launch review)
URLs	<code>/tool/{slug}</code> · <code>/category/{slug}</code> · <code>/launches/{date}</code> · <code>/standards</code> · <code>/submit</code>
.dev TLD	HSTS-preloaded: entire site + all subdomains must serve HTTPS from first deploy; cert automation + expiry monitoring
Social handles	@prother_dev (X), prother-dev (GitHub org), matching LinkedIn — reserve immediately
Trademark	 Domain ≠ trademark. Search "Prother" in classes 9/42 before launch spend; hold 2 backup names

6. Product Policies

#	POLICY
P1 Live only	Live, usable URL required; verified at moderation (S1). OSS exception per D2. Pre-launch submitters get rejection + "remind me to resubmit" capture. Re-launch: once per 6 months for major releases, editor-approved, badged
P2 English	All UI, listings, reviews, moderation, support in English. Tool may serve any market; listing must be English (S6)
P3 Reviews	Auth-gated (upvotes too). Makers cannot review own products (domain check). Aggregate ratings display only at ≥3 reviews. Accounts <48h: review enters soft-moderation filter. Competitor reviews allowed

#	POLICY
P4 Trust	"Curated by Prother" is never for sale. Sponsored placements separately labeled, never inside organic rankings. Affiliate links disclosed (FTC) on listing pages from Phase 3

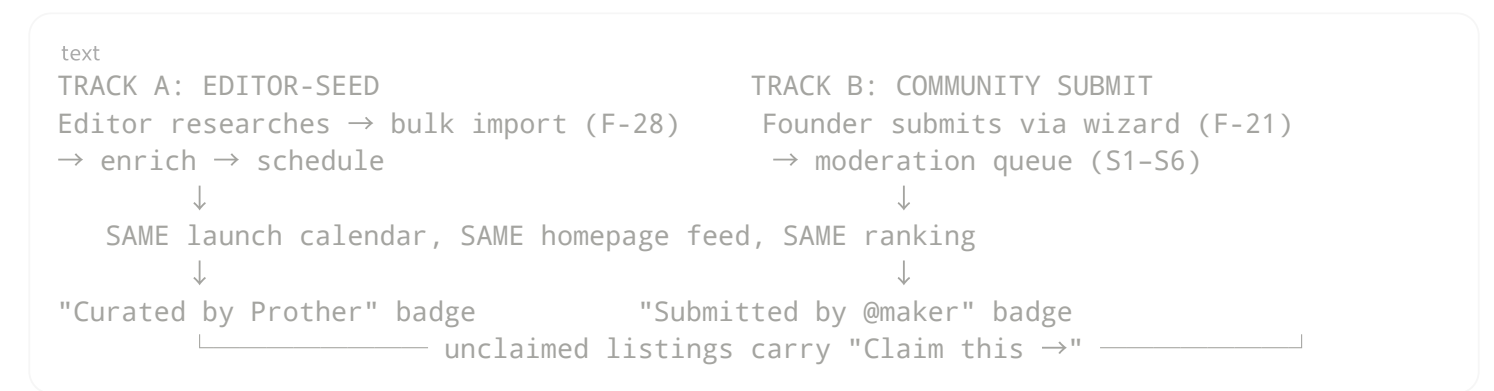
7. Listing Standards (public at /standards)

Every tool must pass all six. The moderation queue is a 6-item checklist mapped to these; rejections must cite failed standard(s).

#	STANDARD	CHECK
S1	Live & accessible — URL resolves; usable now; no waitlists/coming-soon/closed beta	Reviewer visits URL
S2	AI-native — core value powered by AI/ML. LLM wrappers OK if they deliver real workflow value; "AI button bolted on" is not	Reviewer judgment
S3	Complete listing — logo, ≤60-char tagline, informative description, working links, honest pricing	Form + review
S4	Honest presentation — no fake "free," inflated claims, or fake external reviews	Reviewer judgment
S5	Safe & legal — no malware, phishing, or violations of model-provider policies	URL/content check
S6	English listing — listing content in English	Form review

Public page framing: *"Every tool on Prother passes all six standards before it can launch. Curation is never paid. Sponsored placements are always labeled."* (Full copy: Appendix E.)

8. Supply Model — Dual-Track (D7)



Roles

ROLE	WHO	CAPABILITIES
Editor (admin)	You	All: edit any listing, bulk import, approve/reject, schedule, feature, taxonomy, claim arbitration. Public profile @prother
Maker	Verified owner (submitted or claimed)	Edit own listing, media, analytics, re-launch requests, review responses (Phase 2)
Member	Registered user	Upvote, review, save collections
Visitor	Anonymous	Browse, search, read, newsletter

Ownership rule: Editor-seeded listings are Editor-editable until claimed; after claim, edit rights transfer to Maker (Editor retains standards-enforcement override).

9. Homepage — Launch Feed

Purpose: answer "what launched today in AI?" in <3 seconds. The homepage *is* the product.

text

prother.dev

Prother

Directory

Categories ▾

[🔍 Search...]

Submit

TODAY'S LAUNCHES

⌚ Resets in 07:42:13

Mon Mar 3 · 12 launches

[New ● | Top Today | Tomorrow (4)]

1 ▲47 [logo] Promptly ★ Editor's Pick

AI chatbots that never hallucinate citations

Chatbots · Freemium · @dana

2 ▲31 [logo] CodePilotX 🔄 Re-launch

Review AI code diffs before your team ships

Coding · Paid · @leo

3 ▲22 [logo] PixelForge ★ Curated · Claim this →

Turn sketches into design systems

Image & Video · Free

... rows 4-12

[← Yesterday · Mar 2] [Browse all →]

THE DAILY LAUNCH

[email][Sub→]

🏆 TOP WEEK

1 ToolA ▲312

2 ToolB ▲288

3 ToolC ▲201

★ EDITOR'S PICK

[logo] Tool

Why we picked it →

BROWSE

+7

https://chat.z.ai/c/0c80c1d0-2fc2-4873-8b0f-9d3085f1d22f

6/33

Feed Mechanics

RULE	SPEC
Window	24h, rolls at 00:00 UTC, visible countdown; auto-refresh at rollover with toast
Tabs	New = submission order · Top Today = live ranking · Tomorrow = scheduled teasers (name+tagline, "goes live in Xh")
Ranking	$score = \frac{weighted_upvotes}{hours^{1.2}}$, recalculated every 5 min (materialized view + pg_cron — Appendix C)
Vote weighting	Accounts <24h old: vote weight 0.5. 1 vote/user/launch. Anomaly flags (burst IPs/referrers) freeze votes pending review
Caps/floors	≥5 launches/day for first 60 days (ops requirement — seeding + founding makers); cap 10–15/day, scales with demand
Post-window	Tools move to category pages/search/archive — never deleted. Permanent launch page per tool
Rows	Entire card clickable → detail page (no external links from feed — keeps CTR analytics clean). Sponsored slot (Phase 3): reserved position 4, labeled, never in organic order
Degraded states	Skeleton loading (3 cards) · <5 launches → backfill card "Explore yesterday →" · never empty

Mobile: newsletter box above fold; sticky bottom "Submit your tool" bar; swipeable Top Week.

SEO: SSR with tool names in HTML; `/launches/{date}` = fresh indexable page daily; homepage targets brand + "new AI tools today," long-tail lives on tool/category pages.

10. Tool Detail Page

Purpose: SEO workhorse + decision surface. `prother.dev/tool/{slug}` .

text

Prother > Generative AI & Chatbots > Promptly

[logo] Promptly

AI chatbots that never hallucinate citations

Chatbots · Freemium · #rag #enterprise

▲ Upvote 47

Launched

Pricing

QUICK FACTS

Mar 3, 2025

9/18/26, 9:44 AM

Z.ai - Advanced AI Chatbot & Agent powered by GLM-5.3-Flash

★ Curated by Prother → now claimed by @dana

[Visit promptly.ai ↗] [GitHub] [Docs] [%] [🚩]

[img][img][img][img] ← gallery

ABOUT – full 500-char description...

PRICING – Free tier · 20 queries/mo / Pro \$19/mo

REVIEWS (12) ★★★★★½ 4.6

Ease ●●●●● 4.8 Value ●●●●○ 4.2

@mira · Verified ★5 "Best citation handling..."

@sam ★4 "Pricing tiers are confusing..."

[Write a review →] ← auth-gated

MAKER – [avatar] @dana · 2 other launches →

Freemium

API ✓ OSS ✕

Verified 2d ✓

ALTERNATIVES

[lg] ToolX ▲

[lg] ToolY ▲

SHARE

[%][in][copy]

Behavior

ELEMENT	SPEC
Visit site ↗	Primary CTA; new tab; tracked (outbound_click) for maker analytics; malware audit on outbound links
Ratings block	Hidden until ≥3 reviews; below: "2 reviews so far — ratings unlock at 3"
Write a review	Auth-gated; maker self-review blocked; <48h accounts → soft filter
Alternatives	Same category by upvotes; Editor may pin ≤2
Claim CTA	Unclaimed only — banner "Is this your product? Claim it →" (at launch: CTA visible, processing ships Phase 2 — see F-30)
Staleness	"Verified 2 days ago ✓" green / "90+ days" amber; stale tools deprioritized in listings
Re-launch	🔄 Re-launched Mar 3 — v2.0" + launch history section
Degraded states	No screenshots → omit gallery; dead site → "⚠ unreachable — last checked [date]"; removed → soft-404 with category link
Report 🚩	Modal: dead link / misleading / spam / unsafe / other → queue

SEO: SSR; schema `SoftwareApplication` + `aggregateRating` (≥3 only) + per-review `Review` ;title "`{Tool}` – `{tagline}` | `Prother`". Target: 60%+ of organic traffic lands here.

11. Submission Wizard (Maker Track)

Purpose: founder with a live product → queued submission in <5 min. Auth required before Step 1.

https://chat.z.ai/c/0c80c1d0-2fc2-4873-8b0f-9d3085f1d22f

8/33

5 steps, persistent live preview right rail (updates every keystroke, with tips):

STEP	FIELDS	KEY BEHAVIOR
① Product	Website URL* · Name · "Is this your product?" (default yes)	URL blur → auto-fetch (F-23: logo, og:image, meta description pre-fill). Duplicate interstitial fires here (below)
② Describe	Tagline* (5–60 ch, live counter + "say what it does in the first 5 words" tip) · Description* (20–500) · Category* (radio, 10, one-line helper each) · Tags (≤5, controlled vocab)	
③ Pricing & links	Pricing model* (Free/Freemium/Paid/Open Source) · starting price + note · API ✓ · GitHub/Docs/X	Open Source → GitHub URL required
④ Media	Logo (auto-fetched, replaceable, ≥256px) · ≤5 screenshots (drag-drop, client resize)	Nudge: "3+ screenshots get 2× clicks"
⑤ Confirm	Summary + two checkboxes: ☒ "My tool is live and usable right now" ☒ "I've read the Listing Standards (S1–S6)" → Submit	

Duplicate interstitial (on Step 1 URL blur):

⚠ This tool may already be on Prother → [logo] Promptly · ▲47 · Listed by @dana
[This is my product → Claim it] · [It's a different tool → Continue] · [Cancel]

Rate limits: 3 submissions/account/7 days · 1 per domain · no anonymous submissions.

Post-submit states: Submitted → "in review, typically 24h" + status tracking · Rejected → email names failed standard(s) + one-click resubmit; if S1 (pre-launch) detected → "Remind me to resubmit [date]" capture · Approved → "Editor will schedule your launch — 72h notice + launch kit."

Editor mode on the same form: "Editor tools" drawer (schedule directly, skip queue, mark seed-track). Primary bulk path is the import tool (Appendix A); form is for one-offs.

12. Editor's Launch Calendar (Editor-only)

Purpose: you are air-traffic controller. Enforces floor/cap; drag-and-drop scheduling.

text

prother.dev/admin/calendar

UTC 14:32

[Week][Month][List]

9/18/26, 9:44 AM

Z.ai - Advanced AI Chatbot & Agent powered by GLM-5.3-Flash

◀ Mar 3 – Mar 9 ▶

Floor ≥5 · Cap ≤15

[+ New draft]

MON 3

TUE 4

WED 5

THU 6

FRI 7

SAT 8

SUN 9

12

9

8

11

4

2

3

(live)

[cards]

[cards]

[cards]

[cards]

[cards]

[cards]

UNSCHEDULED POOL (47)

[Category▼]

[Seed/Submitted▼]

[Readiness▼]

[▪ ToolX seed/✓]

[▪ ToolY sub/✓]

[▪ ToolZ sub/△]

[▪ ToolW seed/✓]...

Click card → panel: schedule date, ☐ Editor's Pick, ☐ Pin #1-3, warnings,

ELEMENT	SPEC
Capacity chip	<5 (below floor) · 5–10 · 11–15 · blocked at 15 (drop rejected)
Drag & drop	Pool→day = schedule; card→card = reorder; day→day = reschedule (past days locked, link to archive). Keyboard accessible (WCAG)
Card badges	seed/sub (track) · ✓ ready / △ incomplete · re-launch
Pool filters	Category, track, readiness, oldest-queued-first (submission fairness)
Auto-warnings	Day under floor · category concentration ("3 Coding tools Wednesday") · re-launch cooldown blocked · duplicate domain (<6 mo) · stale queue (">14 days waiting") · supply forecast ("pool runs dry Mar 18") ← most valuable number on screen

Principle: never auto-schedules — every day is an explicit editorial choice; warnings make the right schedule obvious. Target: 5 min each morning. Past days show final vote counts.

13. Category Taxonomy & Tags

10 primary categories (one per tool) — seeded in DB (Appendix C):

SLUG	NAME	SEED TARGET
generative-ai-chatbots	Generative AI & Chatbots	80
art-image-video	AI Art, Image & Video	70
coding-tools	AI Coding Tools & Assistants	70
writing-productivity	AI Writing & Productivity	50

SLUG	NAME	SEED TARGET
data-analysis	 AI for Data Analysis & Prediction	50
infra-devtools	 AI Infrastructure & DevTools	50
audio-voice-music	 AI Audio, Voice & Music	40
agents-automation	 AI Agents & Automation	40
vertical-ai	 Vertical AI (Healthcare/Legal/Finance/Education/Marketing)	30
safety-governance	 AI Safety, Ethics & Governance	20

Cross-cutting tags (≤5 per tool, controlled vocabulary v1):
open-source · free-tier · api-available · self-hosted · no-code · enterprise · browser-extension · mobile

Rules: Editor-managed taxonomy (no deploys); category pages = SEO landing pages with unique intro copy; quarterly taxonomy review.

14. Functional Requirements

Priorities: P0 = MVP (W14 launch) · P1 = Phase 2 (W15–22) · P2 = Phase 3 (W23–34).

A. Discovery & Feed

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRI
F-01	Homepage launch feed per §9 (tabs, countdown, UTC rollover, ranking recalc 5 min)	P0
F-02	Directory/archive browsing: sort day/week/month/all-time	P0
F-03	Category browse pages w/ curated SEO intro copy	P0
F-04	Search: Postgres full-text (name A / tagline B / description C weights)	P0
F-05	Filters: pricing model, OSS status, audience, tags	P0

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRI
F-06	Trending algorithm for week/month windows (velocity + CTR)	P1
F-07	Launch archive pages <code>/launches/{date}</code> (daily indexable)	P0
F-08	Comparison view: 2–4 tools side-by-side	P1
F-09	Curated Collections (editor-authored lists)	P1
F-10	Semantic search ("tools that turn podcasts into blog posts")	P2
F-11	Personalized recommendations from upvote/save history	P2

B. Tool Detail

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRI
F-12	Structured detail page per \$10	P0
F-13	Pricing fields (model, starting price + note, API flag)	P0
F-14	Upvotes: auth, 1/user/launch, <24h accounts weight 0.5, anomaly flagging	P0
F-15	Alternatives section (auto + ≤2 editor pins)	P1
F-16	Reviews: account-gated, 3 ratings + body (20–2000 ch), maker self-block, <48h soft filter, aggregate display ≥3 reviews	P1
F-17	"Verified User" review badge (referral-based)	P2
F-18	Last-verified timestamp; quarterly maker re-verify; stale demotion; auto link-liveness checks	P2
F-19	Maker analytics: views, upvotes, CTR, outbound clicks (events table)	P1
F-20	Report/flag on all listings & reviews → queue	P1

C. Submissions (Dual-Track)

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRI
F-21	5-step submission wizard w/ live preview per §11	P0
F-22	Step-5 attestations (live + standards)	P0
F-23	Metadata auto-fetch at import/submission (logo, og:image, meta desc; never auto-writes copy)	P0
F-24	Duplicate detection: exact URL blocked; name/URL trigram match warns + interstitial w/ claim shortcut	P0
F-25	Anti-spam: rate limits (3/acct/7d, 1/domain), velocity caps, domain blocklist	P0
F-26	Structured rejection: failed standards + one-click resubmit	P0
F-27	Pre-launch "remind me to resubmit" capture	P1
F-28	Bulk import tool (CSV/XLSX ≤1000 rows; partial success; per-row error report keyed to <code>ref</code> ; upsert on re-import) — full contract in Appendix A	P0
F-29	Import auto-fetch pass (fills blank logos; flags incomplete drafts)	P0

D. Claims & Ownership

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRI
F-30	Claim flow: "Is this your product?" CTA on unclaimed listings; verification via email @domain / DNS TXT / meta tag / GitHub push access; on success → rights transfer + dashboard unlock. <i>CTA visible from launch (routes to email interim); full flow GA in Phase 2. False claims fail by design; disputes → Editor arbitration</i>	P1
F-31	Attribution badges:  Curated by Prother (gold) / Submitted by @maker (neutral); unclaimed variant adds	P1

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRI
	"Claim this →"	
F-32	Maker dashboard: listing editor, media, analytics, re-launch requests	P1

E. Launches & Scheduling

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRI
F-33	Launch scheduling: Editor controls all launch days in v1 (community subs land in queue; Editor picks day; 72h maker notice)	P0
F-34	Editor launch calendar per §12 (floor/cap enforcement, drag-drop, warnings, supply forecast)	P0
F-35	Re-launch: maker-initiated request, 6-month cooldown (DB-enforced <code>can_launch</code>), editor approval, badge, fresh vote pool	P1
F-36	Ranking infrastructure: materialized <code>todays_ranking</code> + <code>pg_cron</code> 5-min refresh (Appendix C §6)	P0

F. Community & Accounts

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRI
F-37	Auth: email + Google OAuth + magic links	P0
F-38	Profiles: avatar, bio (≤280), upvote history, saved tools; public editor profile <code>@prother</code>	P0
F-39	Personal (private) collections	P0
F-40	Public shareable collections	P1
F-41	Follow makers/categories + activity digest	P1
F-42	Comments on launch pages (one level deep — DB-enforced)	P1

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRI
F-43	Editorial badges: Editor's Choice, Top Rated, Open Source Gem	P1
F-44	Karma/reputation tied to anti-spam thresholds	P2

G. Email & Notifications

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRI
F-45	Newsletter signup (homepage, waitlist, exit popup) — double opt-in, source-tagged	P0
F-46	Daily digest: today's launches, top climbers, editor's pick (template: Appendix F)	P0
F-47	Transactional: submission status, 72h launch notice, claim verification, rejection w/ standards link	P0
F-48	Weekly category digests ("This week in AI Coding Tools")	P2

H. Admin & Moderation

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRI
F-49	Admin dashboard: submission queue w/ S1–S6 checklist (approval requires all six pass — DB constraint), feature/pin, structured rejections	P0
F-50	Taxonomy management (categories/tags CRUD, no deploys)	P0
F-51	Domain blocklist management	P0
F-52	Site analytics: traffic, funnel, zero-result search queries	P1

I. Monetization (Phase 3 — gated on 100K MAU or 50K subscribers)

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRI
F-53	Sponsored category-page slots — labeled, never in organic rank, never carry Curated badge	P2
F-54	Affiliate framework: <code>rel="sponsored"</code> , per-listing FTC disclosure	P2
F-55	Featured launch upsell (guaranteed homepage slot, chosen day)	P2
F-56	Self-serve billing (Stripe)	P2

15. Non-Functional Requirements

CATEGORY	REQUIREMENT
HTTPS	Site-wide TLS on <code>prother.dev</code> + all subdomains from first deploy (<code>.dev</code> = HSTS preload; HTTP will not work — includes local dev). Cert automation + expiry monitoring
Performance	LCP <2.5s; Lighthouse ≥90 on listings; CDN images, lazy load
SEO	SSR everywhere; per-page unique metas; <code>SoftwareApplication</code> / <code>Review</code> / <code>Product</code> schema; auto sitemaps; clean URLs
Scalability	100K tools / 1M MAU without redesign; search handles 50K+ listings
Availability	99.9%
Accessibility	WCAG 2.1 AA (incl. keyboard-accessible calendar)
Privacy/Security	GDPR/CCPA; double opt-in email; outbound link malware/phishing audit; bot protection (honeypot + rate limits) on all forms
Browsers	Latest 2 versions major; responsive ≥360px

16. Technical Architecture

LAYER	CHOICE	WHY
Frontend	Next.js (SSR/SSG)	SEO is acquisition channel #1
Backend/DB	Supabase (Postgres 15+)	Relational fits directory; RLS; fast MVP
Search	Postgres FTS + <code>pg_trgm</code> (MVP) → Typesense (P1) → embeddings (P2)	Progressive
Auth	Supabase Auth	Speed
Jobs	<code>pg_cron</code> (ranking refresh 5 min, link liveness)	No extra infra
Email	Resend + Loops/Buttondown	Deliverability + digests
Hosting	Vercel + CDN	Performance, DX
Analytics	PostHog/Plausible	Funnels + privacy

Schema design decisions (full migration: Appendix C):

- 1. Votes reference `launch_id` (not tool) → re-launches get fresh vote pools, feed ranking trivially correct.
- 2. "Maker" is derived from `submitted_by` / `claimed_by` — not a role (avoids sync bugs).
- 3. One `tools` table, status-driven (`draft`→`pending_review`→`rejected`/`approved`→`live`/`removed`) — a submission *is* a tool row; `moderation_decisions` is the audit trail.
- 4. Soft delete (`removed`) — history and reviews survive; soft-404 UX.
- 5. Rating threshold (≥ 3) lives in a SQL view — one source of truth for UI, schema.org, API.
- 6. Generated `tsvector` + trigram indexes power F-04 search and F-24 duplicate detection with zero external services.
- 7. Rate limits / duplicate gating / self-review block live in API routes (service role), not RLS — validation in one place.

17. Go-to-Market & Launch Plan

WHEN	ACTIONS
Week 0	Deploy waitlist at prother.dev (copy: Appendix D) · reserve social handles · trademark quick-check
Weeks 1–4	20–30 validation interviews (feed-vs-directory on wireframes) · build F-28/F-29 (import + fetch) before seeding · begin seed sprint (Appendix A/B) · recruit 30 founding makers

WHEN	ACTIONS
	(guaranteed launch days) · build shared components → feed → detail page
Weeks 4–8	Seed sprint continues (25/weekday → 500) · submission wizard + calendar + email infra
Weeks 8–12	MVP feature-complete (all P0) · QA · soft launch to waitlist — founding makers launch, ≥5/day begins
Week 14 — Public launch	Exit criteria: 1,000+ live listings · 14 days ≥5 launches/day · 1K registered · digest live
Ongoing	Daily digest · weekly Top-10 syndicated to X/LinkedIn · maker outreach (every quality unlisted tool gets personal invite) · SEO program on category/comparison pages

Cold-start flywheel: supply seeded manually; demand seeded via waitlist + digest; the launch mechanic makes *makers* promote their own launch day — every founding maker brings an audience.

18. Competitive Landscape

COMPETITOR	STRENGTH	WEAKNESS	OUR EDGE
There's An AI For That	Huge index, strong SEO	No community, no quality signal	Curation + launches + upvotes
Futurepedia	Clean UX, SEO	Static list, no makers	Launch-day events, maker profiles
Product Hunt	Proven community/launch mechanics	AI drowns in general noise	AI-native taxonomy + AI-intent audience
Blog listicles	SEO traffic	Stale, affiliate-biased	Living database + verified dates

Positioning statement: *For people drowning in AI tools, Prother is the community-driven launchpad that shows you what's new, what's loved, and what fits your use case — unlike static directories, it's alive.*

19. Risks & Mitigations

#	RISK	L	I	MITIG
R1	Spam/low-quality flood	High	High	Manu check

#	RISK	L	I	MITIG
				blockl
R2	SEO-dependency (algorithm updates)	Med	High	News comm direct
R3	Incumbents copy community features	Med	Med	Speec editor
R4	Taxonomy drifts as AI shifts	High	Med	Editor quarte
R5	Stale/dead listings accumulate	High	Med	Quart livene (F-18)
R6	Monetization erodes trust	Med	High	Strict curati
R7	Cold start	Med	High	500 p make days
R8	Vote manipulation distorts homepage	Med	High	Age-v anom policy
R9	Live-only shrinks top-of- funnel	Med	Med	"Rem 27); re
R10	"Prother" trademark conflict	Low–Med	High	Searc backu
R11	Solo-editor bottleneck (supply & moderation depend on you)	High	Med	Impor shifts publis consis foreca runs c

20. Milestones

WHEN	MILESTONE	EXIT CRITERIA
W0	Waitlist live	HTTPS page capturing emails; handles reserved; trademark check done
W2	Validation complete	20+ interviews; taxonomy + standards signed off
W4	Import tooling shipped	F-28/F-29 pass test import — seeding unblocked
W4–8	Seed sprint	500 drafts imported, enriched, S1–S6 passed, scheduled
W6	P0 screens built	Feed, detail, wizard, calendar in staging
W12	MVP feature-complete	All P0 pass QA; soft launch begins
W14	Public launch	1,000+ listings · 14 days ≥5 launches/day · 1K users · digest live
W22	Phase 2 complete	Reviews, claims GA, comparisons, collections, profiles, comments, re-launch
W30	Monetization live	First sponsored listings + affiliate integrations
W52	Annual review	Against \$3 targets

21. Open Items

#	ITEM	OWNER	DUE
O1	Trademark clearance result + 2 backup names	You	W0
O2	OG image asset (1200×630, dark bg, logo + tagline)	You/design	W0
O3	Subscriber-count JSON endpoint for waitlist page	Dev	W0
O4	Final tagline confirmation (default locked: "Where AI	You	W12

#	ITEM	OWNER	DUE
	products launch.")		
O5	Launch Kit assets for makers (shareables, copy templates, countdown widget — F-24 v1.0, now P2)	Phase 2	W22

Appendices

Appendix A — Bulk Import: CSV Template & Contract

Template (tags use | separator; all text quoted; exact enum values lowercase):

```
CSV
ref,name,website_url,tagline,description,category,pricing_model,starting_price,starting_note
S001,ChatGPT,https://chatgpt.com,"Ask anything – AI answers, writes, codes, and analyzes", "The op
S007,AutoGPT,https://agpt.co,"Autonomous AI agents that plan and execute tasks","The op
S008,Harvey,https://harvey.ai,"AI for elite law firms – research, drafts, analysis"."Do
```

(Full 10-row example set covering every category was delivered with the seed kit; format identical.)

Column spec:

COLUMN	REQ	VALIDATION
ref	–	Your row ID; round-trips in error reports; re-import = upsert
name	✓	1–60 ch; slug auto-generated, immutable
website_url	✓	https + domain; duplicate: exact blocked, trigram warns
tagline	✓	5–60 ch (DB-enforced)
description	✓	20–500 ch (DB-enforced)
category	✓	Exact slug from §13
pricing_model	✓	free / freemium / paid / open_source
starting_price / _note	if paid/freemium	Plain number; note ≤40 ch

COLUMN	REQ	VALIDATION
has_api		TRUE/FALSE
tags	–	≤5 from §13 vocabulary, -sep
github_url	if OSS	Full repo URL
docs_url / twitter_url	–	URLs
logo_url	–	Blank → F-23 auto-fetch

Excluded from CSV (system-set): slug, status (**draft**), source (**editor_seed**), timestamps, search column.

Import tool contract:

```
text
PARSE+VALIDATE → intra-file dedupe → DB dedupe (exact err / fuzzy warn)
→ insert status='draft', source='editor_seed'
→ enqueue F-23 fetch per row (fills logo only, never copy)
→ emit report: ref, row, column, error|warning, message
PARTIAL SUCCESS – no transaction-all. Sheets pre-validation (dropdowns,
length formulas, dupe COUNTIF, OSS-needs-GitHub check) catches 90% pre-import.
```

Appendix B — Seed Sourcing Plan (500 in 4 weeks)

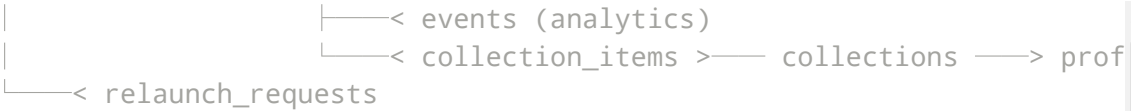
Targets per §13. Priority sources: Product Hunt AI (12 mo) — freshest, heaviest dupe-risk · GitHub trending/topics — OSS tier (needs demo/release per S1) · Hugging Face — infra/dev tools (S2 filter hard; many are demos) · TAAFT/Futurepedia — discovery breadth only, never copy listings · AI newsletters (TLDR AI, Ben's Bites, Rundown) — what's hot now + future promo channels · YC AI batches — funded, high listing quality.

Cadence: 25 rows/weekday × 4 weeks; category weeks in demand order (🤖 W1 → 🎨👤 W2 → ...) so Tier 1 is launch-ready first. The spreadsheet is a funnel, not a quota — skip anything failing S1/S2 freely.

Appendix C — Database Migration (**001_prother_init.sql**)

Entity map:





sql


```
from public.profiles p where p.id = new.user_id;  
return new;  
end $$;
```

```
create trigger trg_vote_weight before insert on public.votes  
for each row execute function public.set_vote_weight();
```

```
create or replace function public.enforce_comment_depth() -- one level max (F-42)  
returns trigger language plpgsql as $$ begin  
if new.parent_id is not null and exists (
```

```

select 1 from public.comments c where c.id = new.parent_id and c.parent_id is not null
) then
    raise exception 'Comments are limited to one level of nesting';
end if;
return new;
end $$;

create trigger trg_comment_depth before insert on public.comments
for each row execute function public.enforce_comment_depth();

create or replace function public.can_launch(p_tool_id uuid, p_date date) -- F-35 code
returns boolean language sql stable as $$
select not exists (
    select 1 from public.launches l
    where l.tool_id = p_tool_id
        and l.launch_date >= p_date - interval '6 months'
        and l.launch_date < p_date
)
and not exists (
    select 1 from public.launches l
    where l.tool_id = p_tool_id and l.launch_date = p_date
)
$$;

-- Homepage ranking (F-01/F-36): weighted votes / hours^1.2, 5-min refresh
create materialized view public.todays_ranking as
select l.id as launch_id,
    l.tool_id,
    coalesce(sum(v.weight), 0) as votes,
    coalesce(sum(v.weight), 0) /
        power(greatest(
            extract(epoch from (now() - (l.launch_date::timestamp))) / 3600.0, 0.5),
            1.2) as score
from public.launches l
left join public.votes v on v.launch_id = l.id
where l.launch_date = (now() at time zone 'utc')::date
group by l.id, l.tool_id, l.launch_date;

create unique index todays_ranking_pk on public.todays_ranking (launch_id);
-- pg_cron: select cron.schedule('refresh-ranking', '* / 5 * * * *',
--     'refresh materialized view concurrently public.todays_ranking');

-- ——— Seed: 10 categories ———
insert into public.categories (slug, name, emoji, sort_order) values
('generative-ai-chatbots', 'Generative AI & Chatbots', 🤖, 1),
('coding-tools', 'AI Coding Tools & Assistants', 💻, 2),
('art-image-video', 'AI Art, Image & Video', 🎨, 3),
('data-analysis', 'AI for Data Analysis & Prediction', 📊, 4),
('infra-devtools', 'AI Infrastructure & DevTools', ⚙️, 5),
('audio-voice-music', 'AI Audio, Voice & Music', 🎧, 6),
('agents-automation', 'AI Agents & Automation', 🤖, 7),
('vertical-ai', 'Vertical AI', 🏢, 8),
('writing-productivity', 'AI Writing & Productivity', ✍️, 9),

```

('safety-governance', 'AI Safety, Ethics & Governance', '🛡️', 10);

Row Level Security (Supabase):

```
sql
create or replace function public.is_editor()
returns boolean language sql stable as $$  select exists (select 1 from public.profiles
                                where id = auth.uid() and role = 'editor')
$$;

alter table public.profiles, public.categories, public.tags, public.tools,
        public.tool_tags, public.launches, public.votes, public.reviews,
        public.comments, public.claims, public.moderation_decisions,
        public.reports, public.collections, public.collection_items,
        public.newsletter_subscribers, public.events
enable row level security;

create policy "profiles_read"      on public.profiles      for select using (true);
create policy "categories_read"    on public.categories    for select using (is_active);
create policy "tags_read"          on public.tags          for select using (true);
create policy "tools_read"         on public.tools         for select using (
    status in ('approved','live')
    or submitted_by = auth.uid() or claimed_by = auth.uid() or public.is_editor()
);
create policy "launches_read"      on public.launches      for select using (true);
create policy "votes_read"         on public.votes         for select using (true);
create policy "reviews_read"       on public.reviews       for select using (status = 'visible');
create policy "comments_read"      on public.comments      for select using (status = 'visible');
create policy "collections_read"    on public.collections   for select using (is_public or is_publicly_visible);

create policy "votes_insert"       on public.votes         for insert to authenticated with check (user_id = auth.uid());
create policy "votes_delete"       on public.votes         for delete to authenticated with check (user_id = auth.uid());
create policy "reviews_insert"     on public.reviews       for insert to authenticated with check (user_id = auth.uid());
create policy "collections_write"  on public.collections   for all to authenticated with check (user_id = auth.uid());
create policy "reports_insert"     on public.reports       for insert to authenticated with check (user_id = auth.uid());
create policy "claims_insert"      on public.claims        for insert to authenticated with check (user_id = auth.uid());

-- moderation_decisions, bulk_imports, domain_blocklist, events,
-- newsletter_subscribers: NO public policies – service-role API routes only.
-- Editor mutations (approve/reject, schedule, taxonomy) also via service-role
-- routes so rate limits. dupe checks. and can launch validation run in one place.
```

Dev notes: slug = `slugify(name) + collision suffix`, immutable · API-route checks: rate limits (F-25), maker self-review block (`user_id ∈ claimed_by/submitted_by → 403`) · events rollup: at ~1M/mo add nightly `maker_stats_daily` , drop raw >90d.

Appendix D — Waitlist Landing Page Copy (`prother.dev`)

Meta: <title>Prother – Where AI products launch</title> · description: "Every day, the newest AI tools launch on one page. Get the daily launch feed and never miss the tool that changes how you work." · OG 1200×630.

① Hero

LAUNCHING SOON

Where AI products launch.

Every day, a fresh batch of AI tools goes live on one page. Prother shows you what launched, what's climbing, and what's actually worth your time — before your feed does.

[[you@work.com](#)] [[Get the daily feed →](#)]

Free · One email a day · No spam, unsubscribe anytime

② What lands in your inbox (3 cards)

 Today's launches — Every new AI tool that went live, ranked by the community. A five-minute scan that leaves you fully current.

▲ What's climbing — The week's most upvoted tools, so you catch winners early — not six months late, in someone's "top 100" listicle.

★ One editor's pick — A tool we actually tested, with the "why" in two sentences. Curated picks are never sold. Ever.

③ Two-sided value

For the AI-curious — Stop keeping 40 tabs of stale "best AI tools" blog posts open. Get a living feed instead: every tool with its pricing, category, and alternatives one click away.

For builders — Launch day, done right. Submit your product free, get a scheduled slot on the homepage, and reach an audience that shows up specifically for AI. Waitlist members get first pick of launch dates.

④ Social proof (server-rendered from `newsletter_subscribers`)

Join {count} founders, developers, and AI-curious builders already on the list. (*Show "Join the first 500" until count ≥ 100.*)

⑤ FAQ

When does Prother go live? We're onboarding the first launch cohort now. Waitlist members get in the morning we open — the first daily feed lands that same day.

What kind of tools get listed? Live, working AI products. Every listing passes our published quality standard before it can launch — no vaporware, no "coming soon" pages.

What does the email look like? One short email each morning: today's launches, yesterday's top

climbers, one editor's pick. Skimmable in under five minutes.

I'm building an AI product. Submit it free when we open. Every approved product gets a launch day on the homepage — waitlist members get first pick of dates.

⑥ Final CTA + footer

Be there on day one.

[email] [Get the daily feed →]

Standards · Contact · @prother_dev · © Prother

Wiring: POST → /api/waitlist → upsert newsletter_subscribers(source='waitlist') → double opt-in via confirm_token immediately · static HTML, inline CSS, <1s LCP · subscriber count rendered server-side · A/B only after ~500 visitors (alt H1: "New AI tools. Every single day.").

Appendix E — /standards Page Copy (P0)

Listing Standards

Every tool on Prother passes all six standards before it can launch. Our editor reviews each submission against this list — and curation is never sold.

1. Live & accessible. The product works right now. No waitlists, "coming soon" pages, or closed betas. (Open source: a usable release or hosted demo counts.)
2. AI-native. AI is the core of the product, not a checkbox. Thin wrappers are welcome if they deliver real workflow value; a notes app with an "AI summarize" button bolted on is not.
3. Complete listing. Clear name, honest tagline, informative description, working links, accurate pricing.
4. Honest presentation. No fake "free" (trial-only must say so), no inflated claims, no manufactured social proof.
5. Safe & legal. No malware, phishing, or violations of model providers' usage policies.
6. English listing. The tool may serve any market — the listing itself is in English.

Rejected? You'll get the specific standard(s) your listing failed and a one-click resubmit. Not live yet? We'll remind you to resubmit when you are.

Footer: Sponsored placements are always labeled. Curated listings are selected only against the standards above.

Appendix F — Daily Digest Email Template (F-46)

text

Subject: Today's 8 AI launches — {date}

From: Prother <daily@prother.dev>

 #1 TODAY

▲ {n}

TODAY'S LAUNCHES ({n})

```
{category} · {pricing}
```

```
... (repeat, max 10)
```

CLIMBING THIS WEEK

1. {Tool} $\blacktriangle\{n\}$ 2. {Tool} $\blacktriangle\{n\}$ 3. {Tool} $\blacktriangle\{n\}$

★ EDITOR'S PICK

```
[logo] {Tool} – {two sentences: what it does + why it passed
the standards when most tools in this category don't}
```

Rules: single column, ≤10 launches, every row links to `prother.dev/tool/{slug}` , send 08:00 ET weekdays (post-rollover so "today" is populated), plain-text-safe fallback.